TALLYFERN

SAMPLE DECISION SNAPSHOT · FICTIONAL PRODUCT

OUTSIDE-IN PRODUCT REVIEW

Decision Snapshot

Tallyfern · AI suggestions review screen

Lenses: AI legibility · Trust · Clarity | Type 2 · Product surface | app.tallyfern.example | October 2026

SURFACE REVIEWED The screen where a finance lead reviews and approves the transactions Tallyfern's AI has categorized before month-end close.

THREE FINDINGS · ONE DECISION

01 **Suggestions arrive without their reasons**
"94% confident" tells reviewers how sure the AI is, but not why, so they open transactions to check. — AI LEGIBILITY

02 **"Approve all" doesn't say what it commits**
The fastest action on the screen gives no hint of what posts to the ledger, or whether it can be undone. — TRUST

03 **The three items that need a person are buried**
Low-confidence items sit among 45 routine ones, sorted by date, at the same visual weight. — CLARITY

NEXT **One product question to decide**
Make each suggestion's reason visible, so reviewers can approve the routine ones in bulk and spend their attention on the few that need it.

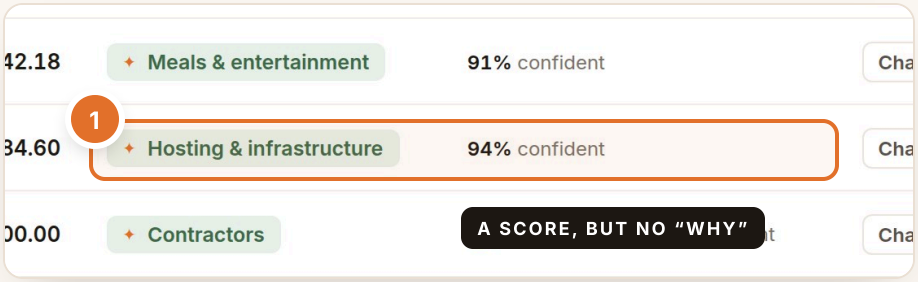
SEE IT → UNDERSTAND IT → POSSIBLE DIRECTION → MAKE ONE DECISION

Sample only. Tallyfern is a fictional product, not a glkFreelance client.

01 Suggestions arrive without their reasons

FINDING 1 · AI LEGIBILITY

SEE IT Visual evidence



AI suggestions: category and confidence, side by side app.tallyfern.example

1 **A score with no evidence**

"Hosting & infrastructure · 94% confident" is a claim. Nothing shows the vendor rule, the past entries, or the invoice it was based on.

UNDERSTAND IT What's happening and why it matters

Reviewers are accountable for the books, not the model. When the screen offers a percentage but no reasoning, the only way to trust a suggestion is to open the transaction and check. The AI saves the categorizing, but not the checking.

POSSIBLE DIRECTION Pattern reference

PATTERN INDEX · AI LEGIBILITY

Trace a result back to its source

Shows how a result can carry a short trail back to what produced it, so people can check it in place instead of investigating.

VIEW PATTERN `pattern-index.pages.dev/patterns/provenance-trail`

WHAT TO TAKE AWAY

The opportunity for Tallyfern is a one-line "because" on each suggestion (the vendor rule or the past entries it matched), visible without opening the row.

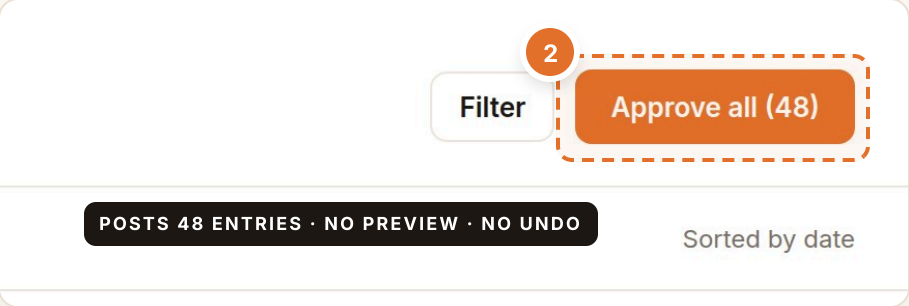
A directional example, not a prescribed redesign.

02

FINDING 2 · TRUST

“Approve all” doesn’t say what it commits

SEE IT Visual evidence



Page header: the primary action app.tallyfern.example

2 The most powerful button is the least explained

It is the brightest thing on the screen, yet it doesn’t say what happens next: 48 entries posted to the ledger, with no summary first and no way back.

UNDERSTAND IT What’s happening and why it matters

Bulk approval is the feature that saves the most time, and the one reviewers are most likely to avoid. When an action feels irreversible, careful people slow down and approve row by row, which quietly cancels the value of the AI.

POSSIBLE DIRECTION Pattern reference

PATTERN INDEX · TRUST

Undo instead of “Are you sure?”

Shows how a short, visible undo window makes a big action feel safe to take, without adding a confirmation step.

VIEW PATTERN `pattern-index.pages.dev/patterns/undo-window`

WHAT TO TAKE AWAY

The opportunity for Tallyfern is to say what “Approve all” will post, and to make it reversible for a short time, so the fast path is also the safe one.

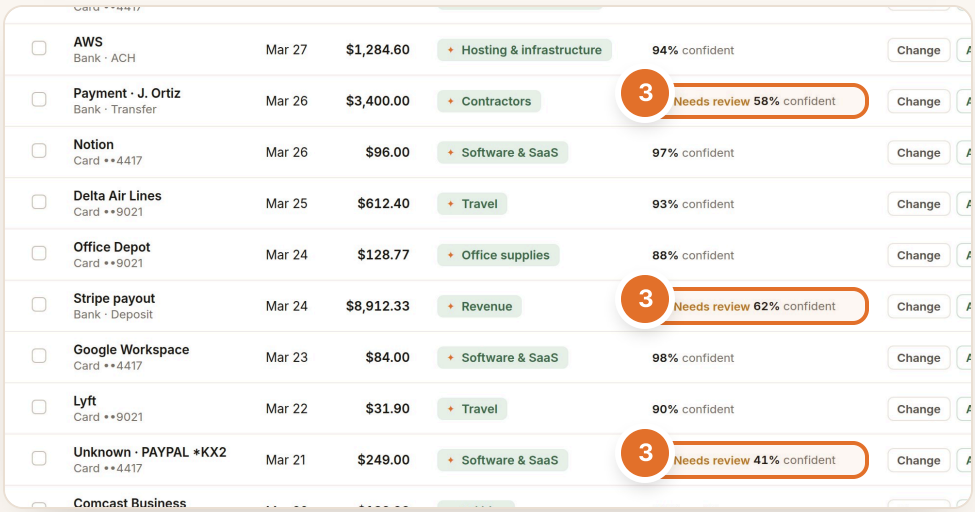
A directional example, not a prescribed redesign.

03

FINDING 3 · CLARITY

The three items that need a person are buried

SEE IT Visual evidence



The list: sorted by date, flagged items mixed in app.tallyfern.example

3 **3 of 48, scattered**

The items that actually need judgment (a $3,400 transfer, an $8,912 payout, an unknown PayPal charge) sit at rows 4, 8 and 11, with the same weight as a $31 Lyft ride.

UNDERSTAND IT What's happening and why it matters

The list treats every suggestion as equally important. Reviewers have to scan all 48 rows to find the few that matter, so attention goes to the routine items instead of the risky ones.

POSSIBLE DIRECTION Pattern reference

PATTERN INDEX · CLARITY

Most important thing first

Shows how a screen can lead with what needs attention and let everything routine recede.

VIEW PATTERN `pattern-index.pages.dev/patterns/priority-reveal`

WHAT TO TAKE AWAY

The opportunity for Tallyfern is to separate "needs a person" from "ready to approve", so the review starts with the three items and ends with one confident bulk action.

A directional example, not a prescribed redesign.

MAKE ONE DECISION · NEXT PRODUCT QUESTION

One question to decide.

How should Tallyfern **show the reason behind each suggestion**, so reviewers can **approve the routine ones in bulk** and spend their attention on the few that need a person?

Why this one: all three findings lead back to it. Reasons make bulk approval safe (finding 2) and make the exceptions obvious (finding 3).

WHAT A DECISION SNAPSHOT IS

- ✓ One surface, reviewed before we meet
- ✓ 2–3 highest-leverage findings
- ✓ Annotated evidence from the real interface
- ✓ 1–3 Pattern Index directions
- ✓ The one decision that matters most
- ✓ Sent within 24 hours, ready to share

WHAT IT ISN'T

- – A full diagnostic or UX audit
- – A redesign, mockups or a prototype
- – Implementation or technical planning
- – Workflow mapping or production specs

If the problem is unclear, a Diagnostic comes next. If it's already clear, I build the fix.

Outside-in observations based on visible interface evidence. Pattern references illustrate possible directions, not implementation prescriptions. **This is a sample:** Tallyfern, Northbeam Studio and every figure shown are fictional; Tallyfern is not a glkFreelance client.

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